
BUYER TIPS
BUYING? WRITE IT RIGHT.
BEFORE YOU MAKE AN OFFER.
Your offer is a written proposal: price, dates and terms
The seller can accept it, reject it or counter
Here's what I recommend you check first
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THE MARKET

CHARLOTTE METRO, NC + SC

SEPTEMBER 2026.

MEDIAN LIST PRICE	$424,950	−3.1% YoY
MEDIAN DAYS ON MARKET	64	+10.3% YoY
LISTINGS WITH A PRICE CUT	26.2%	+0.7 pts YoY
PENDING LISTINGS	4,681	−5.9% YoY

Homes are taking longer to sell than a year earlier. Clear terms still matter.

Source: Realtor.com Economic Research, Charlotte-Concord-Gastonia, NC-SC metro, September 2026



IN WRITING

PUT IT IN WRITING.

- NC: a home sale contract must be in writing to be enforceable
- SC: a contract to sell land must be in writing and signed (S.C. Code 32-3-10)
- List any items you expect to stay with the home in your offer


PRICE
KNOW YOUR NUMBER.
Review recent nearby sales of similar homes with your agent
Weigh condition, updates and time on the market
Decide your top price before you write, not in the moment
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DUE DILIGENCE

NC: KNOW THE DD FEE.

- On NC's standard contract, it's paid directly to the seller
- It buys a set period when you can end the contract for any reason
- It's non-refundable unless the seller breaches, and is typically credited to you at closing
- No law requires one; the fee and the period are negotiated

EARNEST MONEY



EARNEST MONEY, EXPLAINED.

- NC: not required, but common; it shows good faith
- A broker must deposit it within three banking days after acceptance
- End the contract before due diligence expires, and it should be refunded
- After that, it's usually forfeited unless the seller can't or won't perform


SOUTH CAROLINA
BUYING IN SC?
Licensees must put every offer in writing and promptly present it (S.C. Code 40-57-135)
Rejected without a counter? You get a signed rejection form within 48 hours
Earnest money checks a broker holds go into a trust account within 48 hours of written acceptance, weekends and bank holidays excluded (S.C. Code 40-57-136)
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ACCEPTANCE



WHEN IT'S A CONTRACT.

- NC: the seller must sign your offer without changes, and you must be told
- Any change is a counteroffer you can accept, reject or counter
- Until you're notified, you can still withdraw your offer
- Ask for a signed copy of the contract

MULTIPLE OFFERS



IF OTHERS ARE OFFERING.

- NC: until the seller signs and tells you, they can accept another offer, even if yours came first
- The seller's broker can't share other buyers' price and terms without their permission
- Don't assume your offer gets special consideration

MY RECOMMENDATION



EVERY TERM COUNTS.

I recommend we go through your offer line by line, because price is only one term. For contract or legal questions, a real estate attorney can help.

Denise Wilson | REALTOR®
Lifestyle International Realty — Carolinas
denisewilson.lircarolinas.com
704-615-7347

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